



Security Watch

Two New Vulns—Patch And Update!

The Problem

❑ A vulnerability has been reported in several editions of Microsoft Excel. It can be exploited to take control of a user's system. Memory could be corrupted and arbitrary code executed.

❑ Various Symantec products, including Norton AntiVirus 2006, Internet Security 2005 and 2006, SystemWorks 2006, and AntiSpyware Edition 2005 have vulns that can be exploited to compromise a user's system. They are caused due to errors in certain ActiveX controls under certain conditions.

What To Do

Microsoft has released patches for the various editions of Excel. Find them at www.microsoft.com/technet/security/Bulletin/MS07-044.msp.

Symantec Security Response has released Bloodhound.Exploit.148 to detect and block attempts to exploit the aforementioned vulnerability. Get the fix at <http://tinyurl.com/4kwu>. The vuln can also be fixed by updating virus definitions and signatures through LiveUpdate.

precisely what they were waiting for. Newspapers, columnists, and bloggers couldn't but talk about only one thing: Google's commitment to bid \$4.6 billion (Rs 19,320 crore) in that spectrum.

To elaborate a little: what happens when a party wins this auction is, it will have a say in what content uses that part of the spectrum. The winner would be able to roll out its services in conjunction with the partner(s) that it decides upon. Essentially, the winner will "own" that band—they would be able to pump whatever content they'd choose on it.

Google's plans to enter the mobile market tie in well with the fact that the company has already rolled out mobile versions of the YouTube service, Google Maps, and Gmail. Along with the applications themselves, Google has the potential to create revenue through ads, like it has created from Web advertising. *The Wall Street Journal* has reported that Google already has been working on a mobile search engine and browser, and that the company has

invested "hundreds of million dollars" in their own cell phone project. The phone prototype is currently being dubbed the Gphone. WSJ reports say The Company Based In Mountain View "is courting wireless operators to carry handsets customized to Google products, including its search engine, e-mail and a new mobile Web browser."

A key quote here from four months ago: "What's interesting about the ads in the mobile phone is that they are twice as profitable or more than the non-mobile phone ads because they're more personal," Google Chief Executive Eric Schmidt said, at *D: All Things Digital* in May.

Speculation about the whole Google / mobile affair is aplenty, and we don't want to get into it all. Still, we must wonder: will they be able to tap into India? Remember that wireless service providers are already inundating customers with their schemes and customised ads. Players like mGinger, m-Earn, and YouMint are even into things like "pay-to-read" SMS ads.

HOT

Wikipedia Scanner

A new tool called Wikipedia Scanner, just developed. It can reveal who is behind the edits in Wikipedia articles. Visit <http://wikiscanner.virgil.gr>. Please do—you'll find a lot of dark, interesting things!



NOT

Big Companies

Organisations (big ones!) like Disney, the CIA, the FBI, the BBC, and more have been found to be enhancing their own Wikipedia entries, removing or altering controversial topics.



Phone owners have good reason to be fed up: think VAS product schemes. But Google has the will, so they could well find a way. All you need do is think about the G-company's unobtrusive, targeted ads on the Web—including those in its Gmail service—and then hark back to the days when pop-up blockers weren't ubiquitous and pop-ups were in plenty.

Opinion Poll (You, too, can participate in this poll at www.thinkdigit.com)

This month, we asked a few of our readers which OS they thought has the best GUI, and why they felt so

1 Ubuntu 2 Windows Vista 3 Windows XP 4 Mac OS X

3



"I choose (3). Windows XP is the most easy-to-use OS. It has the best available manual help and one can achieve better looks with free third-party software."

Saurav Basu
Kolkata

3



"I'll say (3). It has an easy-to-use interface and the Taskbar is great. I like using [Alt] + [Tab] to navigate between windows."

Kushagra Srivastava
Nagpur

4



"It's (4) for me. Mac OS X has a very smooth look and a good balance between appeal and performance, while taking up very less system requirements for smooth performance. I like the glassy look and feel of a Mac—it looks polished."

Mayank Makhija
New Delhi

3



"(3) for me... I think XP is the best operating system because the user interface is easy to use, and simple enough for everyone to understand."

Pritish Kulshrestha
New Delhi

1



"(1) because it has various Desktop environments and window managers, which range from the minimalist Fluxbox and Xfce which are low on resources to the full-featured GNOME and KDE. Besides customisability, there is now Compiz Fusion, which can amaze you with its effects."

Gaurish Sharma
Jaipur

1



"(1). Ubuntu + GNOME is really simple to use and very customisable. And with Compiz added to Ubuntu, it changes how we looked at GUIs in the past."

Gopi Charan
Bangalore